

# Six Characters in Search of an Author

*Sei personaggi in cerca d'autore* · Pirandello, trans. Storer 1922

A Village Players production · Lausanne · late autumn 2026

Rewritten and directed by **Kiarash Jamshidi**

## AT A GLANCE

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
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| <b>Company</b>        | Village Players, Lausanne — English-language amateur company at SSA Lausanne.                                                                                                                  |
| <b>The play</b>       | Pirandello's 1921 metatheatrical masterpiece; three acts, three parts per act.                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Cast</b>           | Eight live performers. Two stage objects in place of the two youngest characters (the chair-and-coat for the Boy; the wrapped bundle for the Child). Three brief projections on the rear wall. |
| <b>Settings</b>       | Three stripped settings — the rehearsal room (Act I), the dressmaker's shop (Act II), the garden with fountain (Act III).                                                                      |
| <b>Audition block</b> | Seven Thursdays at SSA Lausanne, 18 June – 30 July 2026. Auditions, callbacks, table work, light & sound walk-through, intimacy protocol walk-through, closing read-through.                   |
| <b>Staging block</b>  | Weekly rehearsals mid-August through November 2026.                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Opening</b>        | Late autumn 2026. A short run of three or four performances.                                                                                                                                   |

## THE ROLE

The Assistant Director is the director's second pair of eyes and the director's voice when the director is not in the room. In an amateur company this is most often a colleague from the Village Players, or a friend with directing experience who has been brought in to support the production. You do not direct; you assist directing. Where you are present, the director can focus on the moment in front of them while the rest of the production continues to move forward.

Your work falls into six areas. The list below is complete; nothing here is optional once the role has been accepted.

## 1. IN REHEARSAL, WITH THE DIRECTOR

You take notes throughout each session. You hold the script. You track blocking changes as they are made. You watch for moments the director may have missed because the director was working with a different actor at the same time. You watch for tonal drift, energy drops, scenes running long, off-message comedy. You quietly flag the director when something is slipping. At the end of each session you debrief with the director: what worked, what did not, what to come back to next week. You keep a running list of unresolved questions so nothing gets quietly dropped.

## 2. WITH THE CAST, BETWEEN SCENES AND BETWEEN SESSIONS

You run sub-rehearsals when the director is occupied elsewhere — a Player working on the Madame Pace dialect, say, while the director works the Step-Daughter and Mother on the *It's taking place now* beat. You brief actors who missed the previous session: what was decided, what was tried, what changed. You hold line readings when the director is not in the room. You are available between rehearsals for actor questions the director does not need to answer personally.

## 3. WITH THE INTIMACY PROTOCOL

The production's intimacy protocol requires a third party at every intimacy rehearsal. The Assistant Director is one valid candidate for that role, provided you are not yourself in the scene being worked.

Where you are the third party:

- You are present, attentive, and silent during the rehearsal itself.
- You do not direct from the side.
- You raise any concerns with the director afterwards, in writing if needed.
- You never become the only adult in the intimacy room — if the Stage Manager is not also available, the rehearsal is rescheduled.

The protocol is absolute. No role on the production is senior to it — not the director's, not yours. If anything during an intimacy rehearsal feels wrong to you, you stop the rehearsal. That authority is built into the role.

#### **4. IN TECHNICAL AND DRESS REHEARSALS**

A second pair of eyes from the house — watching the play as the audience will see it, with the light and sound cues running. You flag anything that does not read: a stage direction that is not landing, a cue arriving too early or too late, a sightline blocked, an actor not lit, the pianist's tempo off, the shower-light missing its mark. The director cannot direct and watch the play at the same time; the Assistant Director makes the second pair of eyes possible.

#### **5. DURING THE RUN OF PERFORMANCES**

You watch each performance from the house. You take notes — what landed, what is drifting, what each actor needs to know before the next show. You feed the notes to the director the next morning. You handle the day-to-day communication with the cast so the director can think about the play.

#### **6. BETWEEN REHEARSALS — COMMUNICATION**

You are the director's voice when the director is not on call. Email and message follow-up with cast. Coordination with the Stage Manager on scheduling, room changes, missing material. Distribution of any revised pages. Reading the room for energy and morale across the production; flagging anything significant to the director directly.

#### **WHAT THE ASSISTANT DIRECTOR DOES *NOT* DO**

- Cast the production — the director casts.
- Block the show — the director blocks.
- Give acting notes directly to actors during a director's session — notes go through the director.
- Override the intimacy protocol in any way — the protocol is absolute, and no role on the production is senior to it.

## WORKING WITH THE STAGE MANAGER

The Assistant Director and the Stage Manager are different roles with overlapping territory. In a small company they often work as a pair. Communication between you is daily during the rehearsal block: who is in the room, what changed, what props are still missing, what each actor needs before next session, who is the third party at the next intimacy rehearsal. The director should not be the message router between you; you speak directly to one another, and you tell the director the outcome — not the other way around.

Where your responsibilities overlap — intimacy-rehearsal third-party presence, cast scheduling communication, calendar logistics, the prompt book, room access — you decide between yourselves who handles what for each given week, and you tell the director. The principle: the director should have to think about the play. Everything else flows through these two roles.

One specific overlap to name: where the Stage Manager is the third party at an intimacy rehearsal, you may carry the prompt-book and rehearsal-log work for that session so the Stage Manager can be fully present in the room. Likewise where you are the third party, the Stage Manager carries the room.

## THE SEVEN THURSDAYS — YOUR JOB IN EACH

- **Thu 18 June — Open auditions.** You sit beside the director. You hold the audition checklist for the director when needed. You note auditioner reactions to the room, energy, follow-up worth scheduling. You are not yet the AD of a confirmed cast — but the eyes start here.
- **Thu 25 June — Callbacks & first company meeting.** You help with logistics: signing in arrivals, distributing the Director's Copy and the intimacy protocol, ensuring every performer signs the protocol before leaving. You take attendance for the production's first formal record.
- **Thu 2 July — First cold read-through.** You sit slightly back from the table and watch the company as a whole. The director will be inside the reading; you watch the room — who is reading freely, who is struggling, who is reading *at* the others vs. *with* them. Notes to the director afterwards.
- **Thu 9 July — Act One table work.** Note-taking, prompt-book annotation, watching for off-message comedy in the Players' Lausanne register. The Step-Daughter / Mother dynamic needs particular protection at this stage — flag any drift toward coquettishness or sentimentality.
- **Thu 16 July — Act Two table work.** The intimacy protocol is re-walked in detail this session. **You are in the room for the protocol walk-through itself.** The third party for August intimacy rehearsals is confirmed by name on this Thursday. The voice-recording schedule for the Step-Daughter's projected monologue is set.
- **Thu 23 July — Act Three table work.** The hardest material in the play. Watch how the actors land the Father's philosophical stretch — there is a tendency for it to drift toward lecture. Note the moments where the Son's silence is doing real work vs. where it has gone empty.
- **Thu 30 July — Full read-through with cues.** End-to-end read with the Stage Manager calling cues aloud. You take detailed notes in real time: every cue that landed, every cue that did not, every actor who needs a specific thing before August. Your notes go to the director that same night.

## THE AUGUST–NOVEMBER BLOCK

Weekly staging rehearsals. Your work intensifies. Block-by-block:

- **Mid-August.** Blocking begins. You carry the prompt book during blocking sessions, recording every position, every movement, every staged beat. You and the Stage Manager confirm who carries the prompt book on which day. You run sub-rehearsals when the director is working on a parallel scene.
- **Intimacy rehearsals (multiple, named in the calendar).** Either you or the Stage Manager is the third party. The non-third-party of the two carries other work that session. The intimacy rehearsals are *not* closed; they are bounded.
- **October.** Run-throughs begin. You watch from the house with notes. You are the production's first audience.
- **Tech & dress.** You are the house-eyes — every sightline, every cue, every actor's lighting. Your notes feed directly into the production's last-mile adjustments.
- **Performance run (3–4 nights).** One performance, one set of notes, delivered to the director the next morning. The director needs to keep the show shaped across the run; you give them the data to do that.

## ONE CLOSING REMINDER

The director casts, blocks, and decides. The Stage Manager runs the production's spine. You are the connective tissue: between the director and the cast, between the director and the Stage Manager, between this rehearsal and the next. If you are doing your job well, the director can spend their attention on the play and nobody else has to chase information.

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Village Players · Lausanne · Director: Kiarash Jamshidi

*This document is one of a set: Director's Copy, Actor Rehearsal Script, Audition Pack, Audition Checklist, Production Summary, Assistant Director Pack, Stage Manager Pack.*